

DAY 2: Open Demeanor & Territory Expansion

Companion Action Plan to The Instinctive Trust Skill · Step 2 & Step 3

CORE LAW: Insecurity compresses; instinctive trust expands. When you retract your elbows, clutch objects against your chest, or shrink your posture, you communicate defensive fear. Claiming your territory without aggression projects natural authority.

THE PRINCIPLE IN PRACTICE

Trust is earned when you show that you do not fear your environment. Defensive barriers (crossing arms over your vital organs, hunching over laptops, holding coffees like body armor) tell everyone in the room that you feel vulnerable. Today, you open your frame.

DAILY ACTION PROTOCOLS (CHECK OFF AS COMPLETED)

- ☐ **Torso Shield Audit:** Catch yourself holding notebooks, phones, or beverages directly against your heart and chest. Move them down to hip level or set them on the table. Keep your chest and throat plane completely unobstructed.
- ☐ **The 15% Territory Expansion:** When seated at a conference table, desk, or cafe, place your forearms gently on the table with elbows spaced at comfortable shoulder width. Do not pull your limbs inward toward your centerline.
- ☐ **Shoulder-Blade Anchor:** Three times today (morning, midday, afternoon), roll your shoulders up, back, and gently lock them down into their natural pockets. Lengthen the back of your neck by tucking your chin half an inch.
- ☐ **Uncrossing the Baseline:** During listening periods in meetings or casual dialogue, plant both feet flat on the floor with ankles uncrossed. Feel the physical floor anchoring your weight.

FIELD DEBRIEF & INTROSPECTION WORKSHEET

Complete these questions at the end of Day 2 to solidify behavioral gains:

Reflection Field / Checkpoint	My Field Observations & Honest Notes
Shielding Tendencies What objects was I unconsciously using as shields (coffee cup, phone, folder)? When did this occur?	
Seated Comfort & Space How did it feel to occupy a relaxed, expanded footprint at the table? Did it change my vocal projection?	
Perceived Authority Did people interrupt less or yield more conversational room when my posture remained open?	